Memorandum of Understanding (MOU)
among ARCHR (Asheville Regional Coalition for Home Repair) Partner Organizations

ARCHR Partner Organizations

- Asheville Area Habitat for Humanity (AAHH)/Backbone Organization
  33 Meadow Rd., Asheville, NC 28806
- PODER Emma (PE)
  528 Emma Rd, Asheville, NC 28806
- Mountain Housing Opportunities (MHO)
  64 Clingman Ave. Suite 101, Asheville, NC 28801
- Community Action Opportunities (CAO)
  25 Gaston St., Asheville, NC 28801
- Asheville-Buncombe County Community Land Trust (ABCLT)
  825 Merrimon Avenue Suite C PMB #141, Asheville, NC 28804

Background

The Asheville Regional Coalition for Home Repair (ARCHR) focuses on streamlining the home repair and accessibility programs serving low-income Western North Carolina (WNC) residents. ARCHR is an unincorporated association of Asheville area home repair providers established to increase communication and collaboration among organizations, and to decrease the burden on low-income households seeking home repair and modification services. ARCHR works with historically excluded individuals, including older adults, low-wage earners, households of color, families with children, and people with disabilities to remain in their homes by addressing their health, safety, and accessibility home repair needs.

The formation of ARCHR has been underway for several years and much of the developmental work has been completed by AAHH. AAHH worked with various entities to develop a software platform for centralized client intake, data storage, and project management. AAHH has secured grants for the development work and continues to identify, secure, and manage grant funding for ARCHR projects. This work has led AAHH to serve as the backbone organization and fiscal sponsor for ARCHR.

Purpose

This Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) establishes a cooperative partnership between ARCHR Partner Organizations to ensure that Partner Organizations serving approved families have a mutual understanding of requirements, roles, and goals for a successful collaboration.

Mission

ARCHR harnesses the power of collaboration to provide dignity-affirming Home Repair to low-income residents of Western North Carolina.

Vision

By placing ourselves in collaboration rather than competition, ARCHR models a stronger collective power to positively impact more community members.

Partner Organization Approval

Any new Organization outside of Asheville Area Habitat for Humanity, PODER Emma, Mountain Housing Opportunities, Community Action Opportunities and Asheville-Buncombe Community Land Trust will need majority approval by current ARCHR Partner Organizations before being admitted into ARCHR. As the backbone organization, AAHH has the ability to control the number of organizations operating within the coalition.

Partner Organization Requirements

1. Maintain 501-C3 Non-Profit public charity status.
2. Service area includes Buncombe County but may include adjacent counties in WNC.
3. Ensure all business licenses, state filings, and tax filings remain in good standing.
3. Provide Scope of Services in alignment with ARCHR goals.
4. Operational and project funding independent of ARCHR collaborative sources.
5. Maintain records of all revenues and expenses related to the MOU.
6. Appropriate levels of liability and workman's comp insurance required by grants.
7. Communicate regularly and assign a primary point of contact to ensure collaboration.

Roles and Responsibilities

1. Backbone Organization

- **AAHH serves as initial backbone organization for ARCHR**
    - AAHH will serve as a temporary backbone organization as long as feasible while working to identify a permanent outside organization to serve the role.
        - AAHH will create and maintain necessary software platforms and technology.
        - AAHH will determine ARCHR annual budget with input from partner organizations.
        - AAHH will secure and manage grant funds for ARCHR.
        - AAHH will handle ARCHR backbone personnel decisions.
        - AAHH will serve as fiscal sponsor for awards from public and private outside agencies. AAHH will collaborate with ARCHR Partner Organizations to ensure seamless communication regarding funding opportunities and requirements, while respecting client confidentiality and adhering to applicable privacy laws.

2. ARCHR Partner Organizations

- **ARCHR Partner Organizations provide no-cost/affordable services for qualified residents to include, but not limited to:**
    - Home repairs.
        - Needed structural and systems work, no cosmetic-only work.
    - Weatherization and efficiency upgrades.
        - Includes HVAC repair/replacement
    - Aging-in-place and accessibility modifications.

- **Collaboration with ARCHR Partner Organizations**
    - Partner Organizations will work together as needed to ensure that approved families have access to a comprehensive range of benefits and services.
    - Respect the confidentiality of all families served through this partnership.

- Regularly communicate to assess the progress and success of the partnership.
- Provide mutual support in areas of outreach and education for families seeking home repair and accessibility services.
- Regularly attend ARCHR partner organization meetings.
- Provide complete, timely and accurate data entry into Airtable platform.
- Operate in a professional and respectful manner while providing services and participating in meetings.
- Collaborate to make any necessary changes/additions to MOU.

- **Reporting**
  - Maintain complete and accurate records for all residents served.
  - Maintain complete and accurate financial records of all completed projects.
  - Provide complete and accurate pricing on invoices presented to AAHH for payment.

Mutual Understanding
This MOU does not create any legally binding obligations between the parties, but it does represent a commitment to the mission of providing low-income homeowners and their families with access to housing repairs and accessibility modifications.

Decision Making
ARCHR Organizations must have at least one designated representative participating in the Operations Team and/or Leadership Team. The Operations Team focuses on pipeline and project related activities within ARCHR. The Leadership Team focuses on organizational strategy, policy and finances, and Leadership Team representatives must staff at Director level. All decision making at the Operations and Management levels will be done by Modified Consensus.

Confidentiality
All Parties acknowledge it may be necessary to disclose certain confidential and proprietary information in order to perform responsibilities under this MOU. All parties acknowledge that any disclosure to any third party or misuse of proprietary and confidential information could irreparably harm the other party. Accordingly, all Parties will not disclose or use, either during or after the term of this agreement, any proprietary or confidential information of a Party to this agreement without that Party's prior written permission except to the extent necessary to perform services on behalf of the other Party.

Duration and Modification
This MOU will be effective as of the signature date and will remain for one year. It may be extended or modified by mutual written agreement. Either party may terminate this MOU with [30] days' written notice.

[*Signature Page to Follow*]

Signatures

For **Asheville Area Habitat for Humanity (AAHH):**

[Name] eSigned by: Joel Johnson 04/01/2025 @ 19:31 UTC , Joel Johnson

[Title] Home Repair Director

[Date] 04/01/2025

For **PODER Emma (PE):**

[Name] eSigned by: 04/01/2025 @ 20:43 UTC , Kelvin Bonilla

[Title] Home Repair Program Manager

[Date] 04/01/2025

For **Mountain Housing Opportunities (MHO):**

[Name] eSigned by: Geoffrey Barton 04/22/2025 @ 20:58 UTC , Geoffrey Barton

[Title] President & CEO

[Date] 04/22/2025

For **Community Action Opportunities (CAO):**

[Name] , Vicki Heidinger

[Title] Executive Director

[Date] March 13, 2025

For **Asheville-Buncombe County Community Land Trust (ABCLT):**

[Name] eSigned by: Anna Zuevskaya 04/28/2025 @ 13:39 UTC

[Title]

[Date] 04/28/2025

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Geoffrey Barton geoffrey@mtnhousing.org Received: 04/01/2025 @ 15:30 EDT Viewed: 04/16/2025 @ 13:38 EDT Signed: 04/22/2025 @ 16:58 EDT	 IP: 12.69.156.202 Location: Asheville, NC, United States

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